one, against Germany, in Charleroi. I got changed and followed a couple of the other lads onto the coach. I phoned Victoria. She was telling me what had happened to her and Tony, getting in and getting out of the ground. I don't think I'd even had time to tell her what had been shouted at me when Paul Ince came up the aisle:

'Did you stick a finger up at the crowd?'

I just nodded.

'They got a photo of it. One of the press boys has just told me the picture will be in the papers tomorrow.'

By the time we got back to our hotel, Kevin had found out what was going to happen too. He'd been asked about it in the press conference after the game. We were sitting down to dinner when he came up to me:

'David, I heard everything. You've got nothing to worry about. Don't take any notice of anything you read in the papers. I heard exactly what was said. Don't worry. I'll back you.'

He said exactly the same to anyone else who asked. He told the press—and, perhaps, the representatives of the FA who'd have been concerned about repercussions—that he knew the full story and was completely behind me. It was Kevin who gave people an idea of just how far the abuse had gone, how personal and how spiteful it had been; the idea of anybody thinking that stuff about someone, never mind shouting it at them, was horrible. In that kind of situation, no player could have asked for better support from a manager. Kevin Keegan was ready to stand shoulder to shoulder with me. That's exactly what Alex Ferguson would have done in the same circumstances. I think both Kevin and the boss understand how much it means to players to know their manager, whatever happens in private, is going to stick up for them when it comes to facing the media.

In Eindhoven, it wasn't that Kevin felt he should back me because I was one of his players. I got the impression he'd been really shocked and upset by what he'd heard coming from the crowd. And, as it turned out, I don't think he was the only one. Of course there was a big fuss in the next day's papers and, of course, there were people saying some of the same things they'd said about me after what had happened in Saint-Etienne: *he's an idiot, a disgrace and he should never play for his country again*. But it was different this time. I had the England manager behind me and people had a better idea why I'd reacted the way I did. In Eindhoven, I'd been goaded not by an Argentinian